03-06 第2篇

阅读理解（说明文） Why the Ocean Looks Blue

① Stand on a beach at noon, and the sea looks blue. Take a cup of sea water in your hand, however, and you see only clear, colourless water. How can the same water look two very different colours? For a long time, people gave a simple answer: "The sea is blue because the sky is blue." This sounds clever, but it is actually not the full story.

② To understand the true reason, we have to think about **sunlight**. Sunlight looks white to our eyes, but it is made of different colours — red, orange, yellow, green, blue, purple and more — all mixed together. When sunlight goes into the sea, water begins to **absorb** different colours at different speeds. Red light is absorbed first, then orange, then yellow. Blue light, however, is very stubborn; it can travel deep into the water before it is absorbed.

③ This is why, when you dive just one metre down with a red swim ring, the ring suddenly looks darker and duller. At ten metres, it may look brown or even grey. The red light has been "eaten up" by the water. But the blue light is still around, bouncing back to our eyes. That is why most of the light we see from the sea is blue.

④ The sky does play a small role. On a sunny day, the blue sky reflects on the water's surface and makes the sea look even bluer. That is why the sea often looks grey on a cloudy day and deep blue on a clear summer noon. But even without any sky — in a dark cave with clear sea water — the water would still look **slightly blue** under a strong white light, because of how it absorbs colours.

⑤ Things also change when water is shallow or dirty. A shallow lake with a yellow sandy bottom often looks green or light brown, because the light can reach the bottom and bounce back a different colour. Rivers with mud or small plants may look yellow, red, or even black. So the colour of natural water depends on **three things** working together: the water itself, what is inside it, and the light above it.

⑥ Next time you stand on the beach, look again at the sea. Behind its calm blue face is a quiet but amazing piece of science: every second, billions of tiny rays of light are fighting their way through the water, and only the blue ones come back to tell us the story.

根据短文内容，选择最佳答案。

1. Why does the writer mention holding sea water in a cup?

A. To show that sea water is salty.
B. To show that sea water looks different in a cup and in the sea.
C. To show that sea water is not good for drinking.
D. To show that sea water can be used to cook food.

2. According to Paragraph 2, which colour of light can travel deepest into the sea?

A. Red.
B. Yellow.
C. Blue.
D. Green.

3. What does the writer want to show with the example of the red swim ring?

A. Red rings are safer than blue rings.
B. Red light is absorbed by water faster than blue light.
C. Rings get heavier when they go into the sea.
D. Red colour makes divers go deeper.

4. Which of the following is TRUE about the sky's role?

A. The sky is the only reason the sea looks blue.
B. Without the sky, sea water would look totally black.
C. The sky makes the sea look even bluer on a sunny day.
D. A cloudy sky always makes the sea look purple.

5. What is the main idea of the passage?

A. The sea is blue mainly because of how water absorbs and bounces back light.
B. People should not swim in the sea on a cloudy day.
C. Red objects should never be taken into the ocean.
D. Sunlight is dangerous to small fish living in deep water.

答案与解析

1.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第①段第 2—3 句 "Take a cup of sea water... you see only clear, colourless water"
【解析】作者对比杯中与海里两种景象，引出疑问。A、C、D 均偏题。故选 B。

2.
【答案】C
【题型】细节理解题

【定位】第②段末句 "Blue light, however, is very stubborn; it can travel deep into the water"
【解析】蓝光最不易被吸收，能深入海水。A、B 被优先吸收；D 未提。故选 C。

3.
【答案】B
【题型】推理判断题
【定位】第③段 "At ten metres, it may look brown... The red light has been 'eaten up' by the water."
【解析】例子说明红光在水中吸收更快。A、C、D 均无依据。故选 B。

4.
【答案】C
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第④段第 1—2 句 "the blue sky reflects on the water's surface and makes the sea look even bluer"
【解析】天空只是让海看起来更蓝。A 项"唯一原因"被第④段末句反驳；B、D 无依据。故选 C。

5.
【答案】A
【题型】主旨大意题
【定位】全文 + 第⑥段末句
【解析】全文解释海之所以看起来蓝，核心在于水对不同颜色光的吸收与反射。B、C、D 均偏题。故选 A。

词汇注释（超纲词）

- **absorb** [v.] 吸收
- **stubborn** [adj.] 顽固的；不易被改变的
- **ray** [n.] 光线